

Half of the millennials surveyed in 2014 by the Pew Research Center said they didn't believe Social Security would be around when it came time for them to retire. (The age presumption here is a staggeringly young 65 years old. This does not jibe with reality, which has people retiring way older than that.) However, in 2015, *HuffPost* reported that "with government data on tax income pointing to a continuation of about three-quarters of scheduled benefits through the end of 2089, millennials will likely receive some Social Security—just possibly not as much as Americans receive now."

"The government's official position," a *Time* article called "Will Social Security Still Exist When I Retire?" reported, "is that there is enough money saved to pay benefits at the currently scheduled amounts until 2041. The Social Security Administration admits on its website that benefits will likely be reduced after that, barring changes that improve the financial strength of the system." NerdWallet estimates it will be less by around \$300.

Those who believe there will be no Social Security blame baby boomers for sucking it dry, and those who disagree think those people are being hyperbolic and alarmist.

My stance? Trust no one. If Social Security exists, great. That's an extra thousand or so dollars a month. If it doesn't, we have to be prepared some other way. Remember when we were all being told the 2016 election was a lock for the Democrats? Because I do. And who knows what a Republican administration is going to do to the funding for government benefits like Social Security? (I know what. It's to pay for golden Jet Skis for all their friends.)

INVESTING

So where else can you put your money, other than a savings account or 401(k), to ensure a somewhat stable future? Other investments! And not just the stock market but investments in the waves of the future.

In early 2018, I purchased Litecoin, a cryptocurrency similar to Bitcoin but less expensive. (Wow! These are all words!) Bitcoin, invented by an anonymous creator in 2009, is a digital currency that can be sent between anyone in the world directly from one user to another without a bank or other middleman.